



INTRODUCTORY PAPER



2018 ENGLISH

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET
UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

35 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 40 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a pencil. Do **NOT** use a coloured pencil or a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **35 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–35).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other. Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

ICAS

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

Who dropped the cakes?

Rosa and Jack are buying some cakes for morning tea.



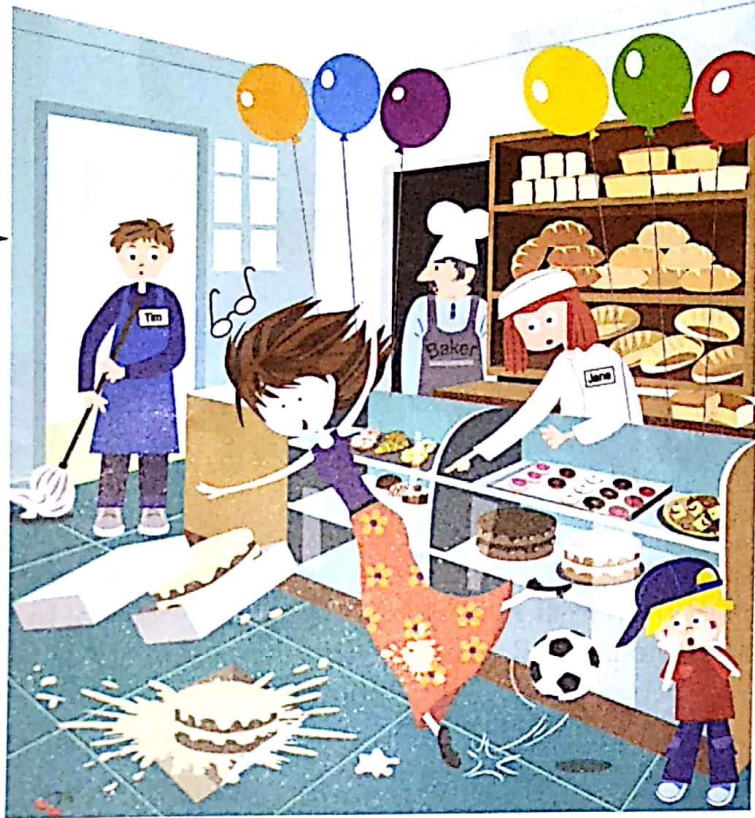
1. Which arrow points to the title?

(A) → Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

(B) → **Who dropped the cakes?**

(C) → Rosa and Jack are buying some cakes for morning tea.

(D) →



2. Who dropped the cakes?

(A)



the baker

(B)



Tim

(C)



Rosa

(D)



Jack

3. What is Jane doing?

- (A) holding the mop
- (B) catching the cakes
- (C) helping Jack
- (D) pointing at the mess

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.



Superhero Eggs

Eggs really are a superhero snack. They are super cheap, easy to cook and full of nutrients! Hard-boiled eggs can be kept in the fridge for one week if left in the shell. Read on to find out some super facts about eating eggs.

Healthy brain

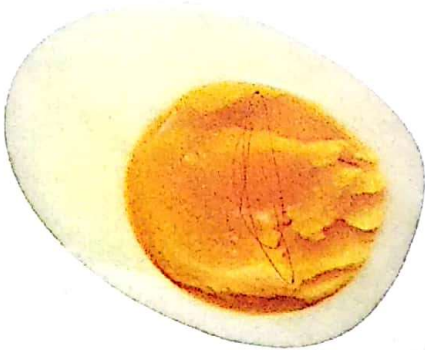
Eggs have lots of choline (a nutrient). Your brain uses this nutrient to help you to remember things.

Healthy eyes

The pigments (colours) that make egg yolks yellow are the same pigments that may help to protect your eyes from the Sun.

Healthy bones

Eggs are high in vitamin D. This helps the body to absorb calcium. Calcium is needed for strong bones.



So what are you waiting for? Enjoy an egg or two today!

4. What is a reason for calling eggs a 'superhero snack'?

- (A) They taste good on toast.
- (B) Even kids can cook them.
- (C) They are good for your health.
- (D) You can take them to school for lunch.

5. Choline helps you to

- (A) see better.
- (B) remember things.
- (C) use nutrients.
- (D) absorb calcium.

6. What makes an egg yolk yellow?

- (A) calcium
- (B) the Sun
- (C) pigments
- (D) vitamin D

7. Which word from the text means 'take care of'?

- (A) 'cook'
- (B) 'find'
- (C) 'make'
- (D) 'protect'

For each question, choose the option that best completes the sentence.

Can you guess?

8. What _____ with t, ends with t and has t in it?

A teapot

- (A) begun
- (B) begins
- (C) began
- (D) beginning

9. What's orange and sounds like a parrot?

A carrot

'What's' can be replaced by

- (A) What is.
- (B) What was.
- (C) What has.
- (D) What does.





The Great Mouse Hunt

It had been a normal breakfast until we saw the streak of white flash across the floor. My sister squealed 'Mouse!' and jumped up onto her chair, dropping a box of cereal everywhere. The mouse darted through the spilt cereal and took cover behind a bookcase in the living room.

'It's just a little mouse,' I said.

Mum and Dad whirled into action. In their frenzy, the dishes clattered, the spoons clinked and the milk slopped onto the floor. Mum grabbed the broom and waved it wildly, shouting, 'I'll get you, mouse!'

'It's just a little mouse,' I said smiling.

Dad ignored me and squatted down beside the bookcase. Mum then used the broom to thump the spot where the mouse had gone. Suddenly, the furry streak bolted out from behind the bookcase towards Dad. Dad crash-tackled the air where the mouse had been. He landed on his back like an upturned cockroach. Did he really think he could catch it?

Mum whacked at the tiny creature with the broom, frantically chasing it as it weaved between our toys on the floor. Finally, it disappeared under a cabinet.

'It's just a little mouse,' I said through fits of laughter.

Mum heard me this time. She snapped her head towards me, her eyes wide. 'No, it's not just a little mouse, Ben. It shows there is too much stuff for the mouse to hide behind. It's time to get rid of some of it. It's time to get rid of the toys!'

Oh dear. This mouse problem was bigger than I'd thought.



10. Who spilt the milk and why?
- (A) Ben's sister when she jumped onto her chair
 - (B) the mouse when it ran through the cereal
 - (C) Mum when she grabbed the broom
 - (D) Mum and Dad when they rushed to get the mouse
11. Which word from the text describes a sound?
- (A) 'darted'
 - (B) 'whirled'
 - (C) 'clattered'
 - (D) 'bolted'
12. Which underlined word in this quotation is an adjective?
- 'Mum whacked at the tiny creature with the broom'
- (A) (B) (C) (D)
13. When beginning sounds are repeated in a group of words, it is called alliteration. For example, 'dogs dig during the day'.
- Which of these is another example of alliteration?
- (A) 'took cover'
 - (B) 'slopped onto the floor'
 - (C) 'waved it wildly'
 - (D) 'weaved between'
14. At the end of the text, what did Mum decide needed to be done?
- (A) They had to move the furniture.
 - (B) They had to throw away some toys.
 - (C) They had to clean up the food.
 - (D) They had to sweep the floor.

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.



Maratus jactatus



Maratus sceleus

Weird and wacky spiders

Some Australian spiders have terrifying names. Funnel-web and redback are names that scream danger. Even the helpful huntsman spider sounds like it could be out to get you. But not all spiders have scary names. How would you feel about meeting a spider called sparklemuffin?

'Sparklemuffin is a beautiful peacock spider, *Maratus jactatus*, with a lovely blue and orange body,' says spider expert Robert Whyte. And it's not the only spider with a funny name. 'Another peacock spider was nicknamed skeletonus, and it actually looks like a skeleton costume.'

These strange names might seem silly, but they can actually be useful. 'Odd names help you remember spiders,' says Robert. 'The dewdrop spider, which lives in the webs of golden orb-weavers and steals their food, actually looks like a dew drop sparkling in the sunshine.'

These fun common names are only half of the spider story. Known spiders, just like all other described species, also have a scientific name. For example, the name *Maratus jactatus*, is the scientific name for sparklemuffin. Though scientific names might be more serious than common names, that doesn't stop scientists from having a little fun now and then.

'A lot of spiders are named after people,' says Robert. Someone named a jumping spider after Robert, *Cytaea whytei*. Sadly for him, it was found to be an already-named spider *Cytaea haemastica*, so scientists use the older name instead. As a consolation, Robert still has the species *Maddisonia whytei* named in his honour.

If you've discovered a new species of spider, what naming advice does Robert have? 'There are rules about naming, which stop you using offensive names, but you can use cute names like abracadabrella, which is a type of jumping spider. These species mimic a fly with two large blobs like fly eyes on their rear end.' The scientist who named the spider, Marek Zabka, must have thought this was pretty magical. Naming is a science with a dash of art and imagination!

15. In the first paragraph, why does the writer use the word 'scream'?
- (A) to add emphasis
 - (B) to create confusion
 - (C) to give a warning
 - (D) to make a threat
16. How does the writer get readers' attention in the first paragraph?
- (A) by providing a story about spiders to make a personal connection
 - (B) by contrasting frightening spider names with amusing ones
 - (C) by testing readers' knowledge of both familiar and lesser known spiders
 - (D) by telling readers how they should feel about spiders
17. According to the text, scientific names are
- (A) more serious than common names.
 - (B) much longer than common names.
 - (C) named after where the spider was discovered.
 - (D) artistic and imaginative.
18. Which word from the text describes the same feeling as 'terrifying'?
- (A) 'danger'
 - (B) 'scary'
 - (C) 'strange'
 - (D) 'offensive'
19. *Cytaea whytei* was not accepted as a name because
- (A) the name was too hard to say.
 - (B) the species only had a common name.
 - (C) the species already had a scientific name.
 - (D) the scientist already had a species named after him.
20. What does the word 'consolation' mean?
- (A) favour
 - (B) relief
 - (C) surprise
 - (D) comfort
21. Which of these words underlined in the last paragraph is used as a verb?
- (A) 'naming'
 - (B) 'jumping'
 - (C) 'mimic'
 - (D) 'dash'

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

LOLA

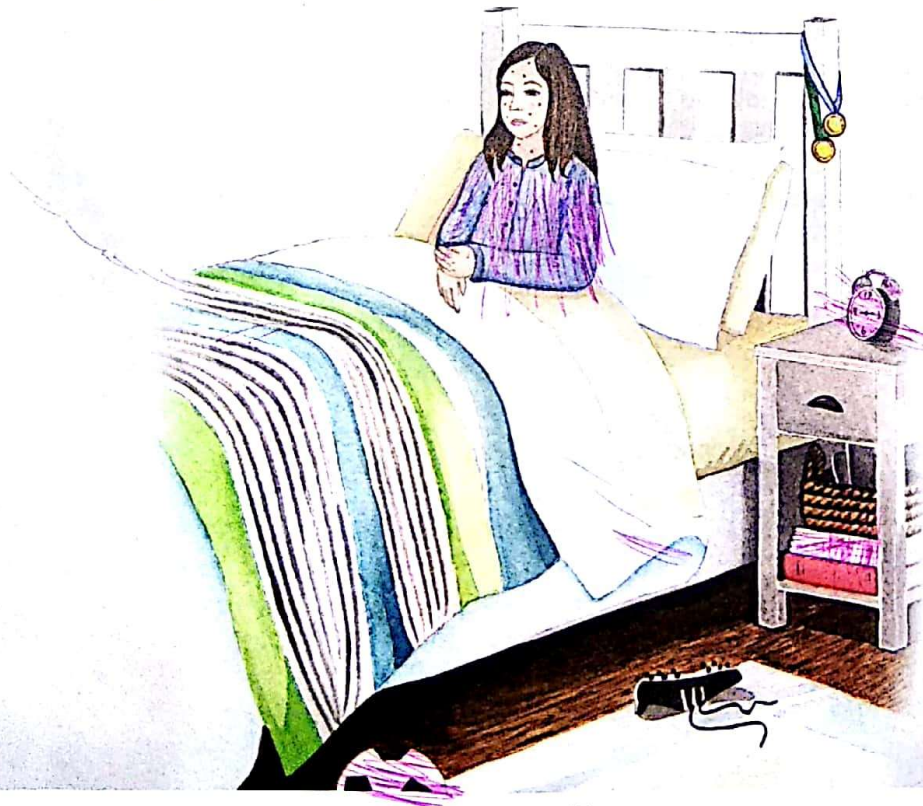
I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning. On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform, get washed, dressed and downstairs for breakfast. But on Saturdays I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds! I know I can do it because I've timed it.

But today I feel a bit weird. It's like I'm in slow motion and my head feels too heavy to lift off the pillow. I can hear Mum downstairs and she sounds so cheery, like she's been up for hours. When I look at my clock, I realise why. It's 9 o'clock! She *has* been up for hours. I've wasted half of Saturday!

There is a plan for today, I'm sure. It starts with soccer. Then home for lunch before Tommy's party. I've been looking forward to it for ages. Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever. It's a science kit that shows you how to make a real rocket. He's going to love it and I know he'll ask me to help him build it. Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.

The phone rings downstairs. I'd usually run and answer it but I feel exhausted even thinking about standing up. When Mum taps on my door a minute later, it's with bad news. Tommy's party is cancelled.

Sitting on my bed, she feels my head and then unbuttons my pyjama top to look at my super-spotty tummy. Tommy has chickenpox. And so do I!



22. Which quotation from the first paragraph tells readers that something different is going to happen to Lola?
- (A) 'I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning.'
 - (B) 'On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform'
 - (C) 'I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds!'
 - (D) 'I know I can do it'
23. Why did Lola say that she had 'wasted half of Saturday'?
- (A) She was feeling unwell.
 - (B) Her mother had forgotten to wake her up.
 - (C) She had slept in later than usual.
 - (D) Her alarm clock had not rung.
24. What do the words 'looking forward to' mean?
- (A) planning for
 - (B) ready for
 - (C) promising to go to
 - (D) excited about
25. 'Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever.'
- What is the effect of the word 'ever'?
- (A) It simplifies what happened.
 - (B) It exaggerates the statement.
 - (C) It shows Lola's determination.
 - (D) It shows that the information is important.
26. Which quotation is about something that happened in Lola's past?
- (A) 'I've timed it'
 - (B) 'It's a science kit'
 - (C) 'Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.'
 - (D) 'The phone rings downstairs.'
27. Why was Tommy's party cancelled?
- (A) He woke up late.
 - (B) Lola could not go to the party.
 - (C) Lola had chickenpox.
 - (D) He had chickenpox.
28. What is Lola most likely to do next?
- (A) She will run down for breakfast.
 - (B) She will make the rocket.
 - (C) She will go to soccer.
 - (D) She will rest.

 To ... Mr Phillips

Send Subject Chopsticks

Dear Mr Phillips,

I am writing to let you know how much I love the changes to the school canteen's menu. So many more students eat school lunches now, especially on the days that the new choices are available. EVERYBODY loves the sushi, and the stir-fried chicken with noodles is very popular too.

But while it is great that so many students are enjoying the new meals, the changes have caused some problems. Many students spend the afternoon with sauce on their clothes because the noodles are very messy to eat. Others are running around the playground eating their sushi with dirty hands. This is not very hygienic and could lead to them becoming sick.

I think that one simple solution could solve both of these problems: chopsticks!

Both sushi and noodles originated in countries where chopsticks are used instead of forks and spoons. This is because they are the best tools for the job. If you think about it, chopsticks are a bit like tweezers. They let you pick up bite-sized pieces of food, like sushi, and pop them straight into your mouth. You don't need to touch the food at all.

They are also handy for getting clumps of noodles all the way to your mouth with one hand. This means the other hand is free to hold the noodle bowl close to your mouth so that the sauce doesn't drip down your front. It is a much more efficient way of eating.

Learning how to use chopsticks might be messy at first, but I think with a bit of practice we would all get the hang of it. With chopsticks we have to sit down and eat carefully too. We really *can't* rush about! This should make the canteen supervisor happy as he is always telling us to slow down and let our food digest properly before running off to play.

I hope you have found my suggestion useful and will agree to buy some chopsticks for the canteen.

Yours faithfully,

Jane Morris (4M)

29. What does Jane use to emphasise the popularity of the sushi?
- (A) italics
 - (B) bold
 - (C) capitals
 - (D) text size
30. What does the word 'hygienic' mean?
- (A) clean
 - (B) good
 - (C) helpful
 - (D) tidy
31. 'Both sushi and noodles originated in countries where chopsticks are used instead of forks and spoons.'
- Which of the following could best replace the word 'originated', as it is used in the sentence?
- (A) were first created
 - (B) were first enjoyed
 - (C) were first valued
 - (D) were first sold
32. Look at the paragraph beginning 'Learning how to use chopsticks ...'. In this paragraph, who does 'we' refer to?
- (A) Jane
 - (B) all students
 - (C) Jane and the principal
 - (D) all teachers
33. How does Jane present her ideas?
- (A) She complains about a situation then pleads for it to be changed.
 - (B) She offers her opinion then criticises other opinions.
 - (C) She identifies a problem then suggests a solution.
 - (D) She objects to the introduced changes then proposes an alternative.
34. Which new point could Jane have used to best strengthen her argument?
- (A) Forks and spoons are not as useful as chopsticks.
 - (B) Students do not need to wash their hands before eating if they use chopsticks.
 - (C) Introducing chopsticks will encourage students to sit and eat their lunch.
 - (D) Children can learn about other cultures by using chopsticks.
35. Jane wrote this in a _____ tone of voice.
- (A) demanding
 - (B) critical
 - (C) lighthearted
 - (D) sincere